With many gifts and open display of favours
He made a place for himself in every heart, he held everyone spellbound

The Amir, with his kindness and natural grace
Treated him as a most honoured guest

He elevated him above all others
And bestowed every mark of distinction upon him

But Burnes had mixed poison into the honey
From London, he had requested much gold and silver

With dark magic and deceit he dug a pit
Many a man was seized by the throat and thrown in

When Burnes had bound them ‘in chains of gold’, the khans ‘swore allegiance to him one and all’. Eventually someone warned the Amir:

‘O Lion-slaying Commander of great fame!

This sedition-sowing Burnes – he is your enemy
On the outside he seems a man, but inside he is the very devil

Beware this evil-spreading foe
Do you not remember the advice of [the poet] Sadi?

It is better to hold back from strangers
For an enemy is strong when in the guise of a friend

You have been nurturing this enemy day and night
Turn away from him before you find yourself betrayed.’[55]

According to several Afghan sources, the Qajar Shah of Iran, Mohammad Shah, also wrote to warn Dost Mohammad about Burnes’s devilish schemes. This letter is mentioned in the *Siraj ul-Tawarikh*, where is it said, ‘talks on friendship and cordial relations had not yet begun when an emissary with a note from Mohammad Shah arrived and was admitted to an audience. The Shah of Iran had written an account of Alexander Burnes’s double-dealing and had candidly stated that because of his duplicity there would be no peace until his impostures were exposed.’[56] But it is Maulana